

Felix Krones, PhD

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Nationality: German

Data & AI Lead

Languages: English (native-like), German (native), Portuguese (basic)
Software: Python, SQL, MS Power Apps, Docker, Git, Spark
Publications: felixkrones.de

Work

Waterland PE (*Data & Analytics Lead, Portfolio Management*)

- Leading the design and execution of data and analytics implementations across portfolio companies.

Munich/Germany

Feb 2026 – present

Quantum Black / McKinsey & Company (*Engagement Manager / Principal Data Scientist*)

- Led the integration of LLM-powered feature extraction into a national customs risk engine in the Middle East, boosting risk detection performance by 31 percentage points.
- Directed scalable LLM-driven ontology extraction from hundreds of medical papers, significantly accelerating the drug development process of a large, Swiss/US based pharma company.
- Developed GenAI roadmaps and virtual expert assistants for banking clients in Italy and Ukraine, aligning AI capabilities with strategic business needs.
- Co-developed an AI optimization solution for energy trading with a major Scandinavian utility, improving real-time decision-making and operational efficiency.
- Led digitalization and analytics transformation projects across European clients, including predictive ML models for churn and cross-sell, and a factory-of-the-future initiative for an S&P 100 beverage company.

Zurich/Switzerland

Oct 2019 – Jan 2026

Independent consulting (*Senior Consultant*)

- Setup a new operating & controlling model for a PE-backed chemical infrastructure provider (>2bn€ revenue).
- Advised on a major restructuring of a global steel group, including disposals and investments of >500m€.

Various/Europe

Jun 2022 – Dec 2022

Mercedes-Benz (*Part-time*)

- Developed a new data analysis tool to support product controlling and development with cost management.

Sindelfingen/Germany

Aug 2016 – Aug 2017

EnBW – Energie Baden-Württemberg (*Intern*)

- Designed and implemented a modeling and optimization engine for power-grid usage optimization.

Stuttgart/Germany

Jan 2016 – Apr 2016

Bundeswehr – Airforce (*Military service*)

- Voluntary military service in the German airforce.

Germersheim/Germany

Jul 2012 – May 2013

Education

University of Oxford (*PhD in healthcare analytics, part-time since 2023*)

Multimodal AI applications in medicine: Improving performance and robustness on downstream tasks

Oxford/UK

Oct 2021 – May 2026

KIT (*M.Sc., B.Sc. in Management & Industrial Engineering*)

Focus on economics, statistics and machine learning; Grade: 1.3, 1.5 (1.0-4.0)

Karlsruhe/Germany

Oct 2013 – Sep 2019

ETH (*Master's thesis*)

Exploration of interaction data of a chatbot-based personality change intervention; Grade: 6.0 (6.0-1.0)

Zurich/Switzerland

Apr 2019 – Sep 2019

NCSU (*Exchange studies*)

Focus on finance and aerospace engineering; GPA: 4.0 (4.0-1.0)

Raleigh/USA

Aug 2015 – Dec 2015

Research and teaching

ETH, KIT, FZI (*Research assistant*)

Digital coaching with healthcare chatbots; occupancy prediction of households using smart meter data

Zurich/Switzerland

Oct 2018 – Sep 2019

DHBW (*University lecturer*)

Introduction to data science

Karlsruhe/Germany

Oct 2018 – Sep 2019

KIT (*Teaching assistant*)

Statistics 1 & 2

Karlsruhe/Germany

Oct 2015 – Oct 2018

Additional information

Social commitments

Deputy District Chairman political party group
PhD student representative
Treasurer, SC Oberschefflenz (soccer club)
Head of local political party group
Organizer of fund-raisers for education

NOK/Germany, 2025 – present

Oxford/UK, 2021 – 2024

Schefflenz/Germany, 2013 – 2018

Schefflenz/Germany, 2012 – 2018

Awasa/Ethiopia, 2011 – 2012

Honors and awards

1st Place PhysioNet ML Challenge
Friedrich Naumann Scholar & Shirley Scholar
Konrad-Adenauer-Foundation Scholar

2024

2022 – 2024

2013 – 2019